

Handover Guide

Everything you need to edit, test and share the games — no coding required.

Who this is for: You don't need to know how to code. You need VS Code, GitHub Copilot, a web browser, and this guide — where things live, how to change them safely, how to test, and how to keep yourself safe with backups.

1 · What this is, in 30 seconds

"The Long Game" is a set of Capital Group-branded investing games. A player gets \$50,000, faces real historical market moments without being told the dates, chooses Buy / Hold / Sell, and at the end sees the big reveal: every moment was real, and simply staying invested usually won.

Each game is **one single .html file** — the words, the design, the data, and the logic are all inside that one file. Open it in a browser and it runs. There is no installation, no database, no build step. This is the most important fact in this whole document: **one file = one complete game.**

That also means sharing a game is trivial: send someone the .html file (email, Teams, USB stick) and they have the whole, working game.

2 · The files — what's what

File	What it is	Do you edit it?
<code>long-term-game-live.html</code>	Live Room — the audience event version. Big screen + phones voting via QR code.	Yes
<code>long-term-game-learning.html</code>	Learning — the solo, product-agnostic version. No fund mentioned.	Yes
<code>long-term-game-sales.html</code>	Sales — the solo version	Yes

File	What it is	
	WITH the American Balanced Fund panel and fund line on the chart.	
<code>long-term-investing-game.html</code> , <code>long-term-investing-game-2020.html</code>	Older prototypes, kept for reference only.	No — leave them alone
<code>VERIFICATION-CHECKLIST.md</code>	The list of every number that must be verified and every compliance sign-off needed before real client use .	Read it. Update it when data changes.
<code>live-server/</code> folder	The kit for running the Live Room on a company laptop with no internet services. Has its own plain-English <code>README.md</code> .	Only if events need it
<code>HANDOVER.md</code>	This document (the master copy — the Word/PDF versions are generated from it).	Keep it current

3 · The golden rules

1. **Back up before you edit.** Before every editing session, copy the game file into a `backups` folder and put today's date in the name (e.g. `long-term-game-sales – 2026-07-12.html`). It takes five seconds and means you can never lose a working game. This is your safety net — treat it as non-negotiable.
2. **Small changes, tested immediately.** Change one thing, save, refresh the browser, play it. Never batch up ten edits and hope.
3. **Copilot is your hands, the browser is your judge.** Whatever Copilot writes, YOU confirm it works by actually playing the game.
4. **Never edit below the "vendored" line.** Near the top of each game file there are two giant walls of unreadable compressed code labeled `Chart.js` and `html2canvas` (they draw the charts and make the share image). They are someone

else's library, pasted in so the game works offline. Scroll past them; never touch them.

5. **Don't weaken the legal text.** Every screen has disclaimers ("Illustrative... past performance..."). Compliance depends on them. You can fix a typo; you cannot delete or soften them without a compliance conversation.
 6. **When in doubt, undo.** `Ctrl+Z` undoes typing. And if a file is truly mangled, delete it and restore today's backup copy (rule 1).
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4 · Your daily setup

1. Open **VS Code** → `File` → `Open Folder...` → pick the project folder.
2. Make your dated backup copy (rule 1).
3. Click a game file in the left sidebar to open it.
4. To **see the game**: find the file in Windows Explorer / Finder and double-click it — it opens in your browser. Keep that tab open.
5. Your loop is: **edit in VS Code** → `Ctrl+S` to save → **refresh the browser tab** (`F5`) → **play**.

The one navigation skill you need: `Ctrl+F` (find). These files are long, but every section has a searchable name. All the "where is..." answers in Section 6 are search terms.

5 · How to make changes with Copilot (the workflow)

You will rarely write code. You will *describe* changes and let Copilot make them. Three habits:

A. Ask before you touch. Select a chunk of code, open Copilot Chat, and ask: *"Explain what this does in plain English."* Do this until you're confident you're in the right place.

B. Small, specific instructions. Select the relevant lines, press `Ctrl+I` (inline Copilot), and describe the change like you'd brief a colleague:

"Change this headline to 'Could you have held your nerve?' — keep all the HTML tags exactly as they are."

"In this scenario object, rewrite the 'story' text to mention rising oil prices. Don't change any of the field names or the month."

"Make this button's background the brand navy (--navy) instead of teal."

C. Tell Copilot the house rules. For anything bigger than a wording change, start your prompt with:

"This is a single self-contained HTML file. Don't add any external libraries, links to the internet, or new files. Keep the existing style. Make the smallest change that does this: ..."

That one sentence prevents 90% of vibe-coding accidents (Copilot loves to add internet-loaded libraries, which would break the game on locked-down networks — the whole point of these files is that they work offline).

After every Copilot change: save, refresh, play through. If the screen goes blank or a button dies, don't debug — undo (**Ctrl+Z** until it's back), then try again with a smaller, clearer instruction.

6 · Where everything lives (Ctrl+F cheat sheet)

These search terms work in each game file:

You want to change...	Search for...	Notes
Welcome screen / headlines / button labels	Just Ctrl+F the exact words you see on screen	All visible text is plain text in the file
The 12 game scenarios (stories the player faces)	const P00L	See recipe 7.2 before editing
The historical era stories (1973, 1987, 2000, 2008...)	const HIST_ERAS	Titles, takeaways, "about" text per era

You want to change...	Search for...	Notes
Starting money (\$50,000)	<code>const START</code>	See recipe 7.3 — also update the on-screen wording
Brand colors	<code>:root</code>	Navy <code>--navy</code> , teal <code>--accent</code> , green, etc. Change here, whole game follows
Fund facts panel (Sales only): ticker, expense ratio, returns table	<code>fund-card</code>	Plain HTML — numbers are just text
Fund line on the chart on/off (Sales only)	<code>FUND_LINE_ENABLED</code>	<code>true</code> = shown, <code>false</code> = hidden
The fund's chart data (Sales only)	<code>AMBAL_NET_2020</code>	△ Read recipe 7.5 — this is approximated data with rules attached
Market data (the real monthly returns)	<code>EQ_2020</code> , <code>AGG_2020</code> , <code>BENCH_0525</code>	△ Don't edit unless replacing with verified data — update <code>VERIFICATION-CHECKLIST.md</code> if you do
Live Room's online service address	<code>const LIVE_BACKEND</code>	△ Recipe 7.7 — the line's exact shape matters
Legal / disclaimer text	<code>disclaimer</code> or <code>Illustrative</code>	Rule 5 applies

Every file also starts with a long comment block (the text between `<!--` and `-->` at the very top) explaining that game's design — worth reading once.

7 · Recipe cards

7.1 Change any wording the player sees

`Ctrl+F` the exact sentence → edit it right there (or select it and tell Copilot the new wording) → save → refresh → check that screen.

7.2 Edit or add a game scenario

Search `const POOL`. Each scenario looks like:

```
{ title: "The world stops", month: "2020-03", emotionalPull: "panic + fear",  
  story: "...what the player reads during play...",  
  mood: "...one-line market feel...",  
  event: "The COVID-19 crash · March 2020",  
  what: "...the reveal explanation..." },
```

- **Safe to edit freely:** `title`, `story`, `mood`, `emotionalPull`, `event`, `what` — that's all wording.
- **Handle with care:** `month`. The game looks up the REAL market return for that month — nothing about the market move is hand-typed. If you add a new scenario, pick a genuinely dramatic real month between `2020-01` and `2025-12` and the numbers take care of themselves.
- The game randomly draws 6 of the 12 each play, always shown in date order. Keep the pool at a comfortable size (10–14) so replays feel fresh.
- Good Copilot prompt: *"Add one more scenario object to POOL about [real event] in [YYYY-MM], written in the same second-person emotional style as the others. Don't change anything else."*

7.3 Change the starting amount

Search `const START` → change `50000`. Then `Ctrl+F 50,000` and `$50k` through the file — the amount is also written into on-screen sentences, and those don't update themselves. (Ask Copilot: *"Find every place this file says \$50,000 in visible text and change it to \$100,000."*)

7.4 Annual refresh of the fund panel (Sales)

Once a year (or when marketing asks): search `fund-card`, update the returns table, the "as of" date, and the expense ratio from the fund's **current prospectus/fact sheet** (not a random website). Then update `VERIFICATION-CHECKLIST.md` §1.1 so the paper trail stays honest.

7.5 The fund line on the chart (Sales) — read before touching

The purple dashed fund line is currently drawn from an **approximation**: each calendar year lands exactly on the fund's published annual return, but the month-to-month wiggle follows the benchmark. That's disclosed on screen and in `VERIFICATION-CHECKLIST.md` §1.1. The rules:

- If compliance/data ever supplies the **real verified monthly series**, replace the `AMBAL_NET_2020` array with it (Copilot prompt: *"Replace the values in AMBAL_NET_2020 with this list, keeping the same format: ..."*), and then delete/soften the "approximated" wording in the fund note and bottom disclaimer — search `approximat` to find all of it.
- To hide the line entirely (e.g. compliance says pause), set `FUND_LINE_ENABLED = false`. The note under the chart auto-switches to a "pending verification" message. That's the whole off-switch.
- Never "improve" the fund's numbers by hand. Every figure must trace to a published source.

7.6 Change the brand colors

Search `:root` (near the top, in the style section). You'll see the palette: `--navy: #083469`, `--accent: #008074` (teal), etc. Change the color codes here and the whole game follows. Test afterwards — especially text readability on the dark reveal cards.

7.7 Live Room: the service address [⚠]

Search `const LIVE_BACKEND` in `long-term-game-live.html`. It looks like:

```
const LIVE_BACKEND = { databaseURL: "https://...firebase.database.app" };
```

- That address is the online "switchboard" that passes votes from phones to the big screen. Replace the address only if you set up a new Firebase Realtime Database (or an IT-hosted relay).
 - **Do not reformat this line.** The company-laptop servers in `live-server/` find this exact line and auto-rewrite it when they serve the page. Change only the address between the quotes; leave the shape of the line alone.
 - Everything about running events (company laptops, hotspots, what to ask IT) is in `live-server/README.md` — written for non-technical readers.
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8 · Test before you share it (10 minutes)

After ANY change, play the changed game start to finish. Before handing a file to anyone, check these specifically — they're the invariants that have caught real bugs:

Solo games (Learning & Sales):

- Portfolio starts at exactly **\$50,000** at the first moment.
- Play a round pressing **Hold every time** → at the reveal, "Your choices" and "Stayed invested" must be **identical to the dollar**. If they differ, something broke — restore your backup.
- Click every era tab (1973, 1987, 2000, 2008, 2011, 2015–18) and back to "Your 2020" — the whole section should swap cleanly each way.
- "Play again" lets you pick a different risk profile.
- Sales only: fund line appears on the 60/40 profile, disappears on era views, and the 70/30 profile shows the "reselect Balanced" note.
- Make the browser window phone-narrow (or press **F12** → phone icon) — nothing should overflow sideways.

Live Room:

- Open the game with `?live=host` added to the address in one window → a room code appears.
 - Join from a second window (or your phone) with that code → vote → the phone should NOT show the outcome until the host presses **"Reveal what happened"**.
 - Leaderboard appears at the end.
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9 · Backups and sharing your work

Your backup system is a folder of dated copies. Before each editing session, copy the file you're about to change into `backups/` with the date in the name. Keep them all — they're tiny. Every dated copy is a complete, working game you can go back to by simply opening it.

Sharing an updated game = sending one file. Because each game is fully self-contained, handing your latest version to a colleague, a presenter, or a reviewer is just sending them the `.html` file. Nothing to install, nothing else to include. (For the Live Room at an event, also read `live-server/README.md` — the audience's phones need a

way to reach the game, which that guide explains.)

If the game ever needs to live on a website (so people can reach it by link rather than by file), that's a hosting request to IT — the file itself needs no changes to be hosted anywhere.

10 · The rules that outrank everything (compliance)

This is a Capital Group-branded prototype with real market data and real fund performance in it. It is currently **internal / pre-approval**:

1. **VERIFICATION-CHECKLIST.md is the contract.** Nothing goes in front of a real client or external audience until the data verifications and the compliance/brand sign-offs in that file are done. If you change any number, record it there.
 2. **Disclaimers stay.** (Rule 5 again, because it matters.)
 3. **The Live Room collects nothing but nicknames and votes**, in throwaway rooms. Keep it that way — the moment someone suggests collecting emails through it, that's a new privacy conversation, not a Copilot prompt.
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11 · When something breaks and undo isn't enough

- **Blank page after an edit:** almost always a broken piece of JavaScript. Press **F12** in the browser → **Console** tab → screenshot the red error → paste it to Copilot Chat with *"This single-file HTML game shows a blank page, here's the console error, here's the code near it — what's the smallest fix?"*
 - **Chart looks wrong / numbers seem off:** re-run the Section 8 checklist, especially the all-Hold tie. If the tie fails, your change touched game math — restore your backup and re-approach with a narrower prompt.
 - **Live Room won't connect:** it fails loudly with an on-screen message after ~8 seconds instead of hanging. The message itself lists the likely causes (corporate network blocking, etc.). [live-server/README.md](#) has the full plain-English troubleshooting list, including the phone-hotspot fallback for events.
 - **Totally lost:** open today's backup copy from your **backups** folder — it's a complete working game. Rename it back and you're exactly where you started the day.
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12 · Tiny glossary

Word	Meaning here
HTML / CSS / JavaScript	The words / the styling / the behavior — all inside the one file
Firebase	Google's small online service the Live Room uses to pass votes around
Relay / <code>live-server</code>	The bundled do-it-yourself alternative to Firebase for company laptops
<code>const SOMETHING =</code> <code>...</code>	"Here is a named value the game uses" — the settings knobs live in lines like this
Vendored library	Someone else's finished code pasted into the file so the game works offline — never edit it

The Long Game · Handover Guide · July 2026 · The file `HANDOVER.md` in the project folder is the master copy of this document.